

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader moving closer to the model — shipping an AI copilot skill, an end-to-end AI fundraising ecosystem, and a design-system-as-API

CONTACT

LOCATION

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PORTFOLIO

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University
2022 – Present

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching; design-thinking and product-strategy consulting for non-profits, religious organisations, and mission-driven ventures.

PROFILE

Design leader who moved closer to the model this past year. At Bibel TV: an MS Copilot skill for customer support, an AI fundraising ecosystem built solo, and a design-system-as-API live across Android and Figma. 15+ years leading design across Datameer (five-year cross-Atlantic tenure), Ninox (SLT + prompt-to-database onboarding with the CEO), and ChurchDesk.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C media platform across mobile, web, and connected TV) Hamburg (2 days/week) + Berlin (Remote), Germany

- Shipped a customer-support AI copilot on the MS Copilot platform, drafting replies to viewer letters and emails against the CS handbook as context
- Scoped what the skill loads and defined "good draft" with the CS team before prompt-tuning — kept the human send-decision absolute
- Made escalation a first-class output for acute-crisis messages — routes out rather than drafts
- Live in production, introduced through a self-testing week then 1:1 sessions with the CS team, adopted across the whole team, including the most sceptical members
- Built the AI fundraising ecosystem end-to-end, solo — analysis, prompt engineering, prototype, and skill work all shipped by me
- Analysed past source material and its performance to identify seasonality and style patterns separating over- from under-performers
- Encoded analysis and style guide into a Claude Project with a multi-turn clarifying-question loop before generation, not single-shot
- Built a web prototype for the generation flow
- Built a Claude skill producing follow-up content across three surfaces — in-app notifications, web banners, and video scripts
- Introduced agentic engineering as design practice — new Bibel TV experience prototyped first for web, then Android, on real APIs with real video content
- Engineering consumes prototype code directly, and ~70% of AI-generated code ships with minor modifications
- Iteration speed collapsed from days through spec-and-handoff to hours in working code
- Established the design system as an API — DTCG-standard token repository with a three-tier hierarchy (global primitives → semantic → component)
- Style Dictionary build with multi-platform sync — Android live, Figma live via plugin, iOS/web endpoints ready
- Architecture supports server-driven UI, so one commit propagates to every platform automatically
- Consistency enforced by infrastructure, not documentation
- Leading the mobile app redesign for engagement and retention across iOS / Android / web / connected TV
- Partnering with engineering on the experimentation framework and A/B testing infrastructure for rapid iteration

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk GmbH (European church-management SaaS across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Shipped AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance in production — production AI in a regulated environment
- Under GDPR + Protestant/Catholic church data-protection law across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH
- Established automated accessibility design processes across customer-facing content
- Delivered a suite of CS-workflow modules to help client churches automate remote processes
- Shared inbox with multi-user team-inbox routing, case-management ticket system, and booking system for core church processes
- Parish staff as agent-equivalent users — customer-support-domain adjacency
- Dual PM + Design on the Booking System (€20k, 2-month): reframed "funeral-booking feature" into a booking capability deeply integrated into the platform
- Owned build-vs-buy and standalone-vs-integrated decisions
- 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% booking acceptance rate, 20+ cemeteries in the Hanau region
- Adopted as a core platform feature beyond the initial Hessen region — multi-stakeholder coordination across funeral homes, pastors, cemeteries, and families
- Managed 1 direct report (designer)
- Main customer-facing contact for the launch parish across a multi-jurisdiction regulated environment

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (AI-powered no-code business platform, DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Co-defined the prompt-to-database AI onboarding model with Ninox's CEO and technical co-founder in founder-led stealth, before the initiative was handed to the product team
- Prompt-to-database with split-screen direct manipulation, and suggested-actions chips proposing next moves
- AI-generated schema renders into the real Ninox data-model editor, not a chat preview

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Remote — Chat and direct manipulation coexist with first use schema is wrong handled as the normal case from "60-second automated journey" to control the data model as interactive tool (agency, no Feb 2020) · Peer-user-agency principle explicit: "show output, onboarding redesign" · Allowed users to edit

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA — first mobile revenue stream via free analysis · Managed 5 direct reports including a design lead (1 writer among them)

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA — client-facing UX work at a design consultancy

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA — international microfinance non-profit, responsive design and cross-cultural accessibility

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Remote — The engineer engagement of the strongest design work for structured habits spread beyond the German agency accommodation and became team norm

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Remote — Made performance calls in both directions: hired 1 designer + 1 writer, let go 1 designer + 1 writer SME clients · Actively shaped team composition and recruiting bar (includes the earlier interim Head of Product period, 2023, folded into this tenure)

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Remote — early-career web design

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugmaschinen* · 2000 – 2001 · Remote — many — first e-commerce role

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service center; service-to-product transformation)* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

SKILLS

AI-Layer Product Design (Model-Adjacent Building)

AI copilot agent scoping on the MS Copilot platform (you own the department on ITSM, services desk, helpdesk, output; human-in-the-loop send decision) · Claude Project design with follow-up-question loops for human-clarification workflows · Claude skill design for multi-surface content generation (in-app notifications / web banners / video scripts) · Prompt engineering as design method · Source-material performance analysis for AI content generation · "Show output, allow users to edit" user-agency principle · Agentic engineering as design practice (Claude Code, Cursor, real APIs, engineering consumes prototype code) · Designing with and for AI workshop curriculum

Director of Design

AI-Native Interaction & Agent Workflow Design

prompt-to-database interaction patterns (prompt-to-database; split-screen direct manipulation; suggested-actions chips) · Multi-turn AI clarification-loop led the design team across Germany and NYC for 5 years · 6-hour time-zone gap · Human-in-the-loop AI workflows · Production of a time-boxed strategic initiatives methodology (persona development, lighthouse design projects) to balance strategic and tactical work across the difference

Sustained design consistency through written decisions and async rituals

Design Systems as Infrastructure (Functional-Craft Quality Bar)

Design-system-as-API · DTCG-standard token strict regulatory environment, pioneered iterative user testing, personas / component) · Multi-platform sync (Android / iOS / Web / Figma / connected TV) · Style Dictionary build automation · Server-driven UI architecture · Shared design system across engineering + design · Storybook + Figma Variables + Tokens

rebuild the design system from scratch

Elevated design from execution-focused function to strategic business partner

Design Leadership (Peer-in-Craft Management + SLT Parity)

Head-of-design roles since 2016 across four companies (Datameer / Ninox / ChurchDesk / Bibel TV) · Senior Leadership Team participation · Managed 5 ICs + 1 design lead at Ninox with SLT membership · Coaching a design lead through stakeholder conflict · Hiring and performance calls in both directions · Cross-functional Agile process design · Mentoring writers and content roles into higher-level leadership · Lateral peer-craft mentoring (Oratio&Co, CareerFoundry decade, IxDF, UX School Advisory)

Distributed-Team & Regulated-Environment Fluency

Cross-Atlantic distributed-team leadership (Germany + NYC, 6-hour gap, 5-year sustained) · Time-boxed strategic-initiatives methodology · Written-first async rituals · Regulated-industry banking / insurance research access at Datameer · GDPR + Protestant/Catholic church-data-protection law at ChurchDesk · EU accessibility compliance · EU AI Act exposure · Metric ownership (70% / 90% / 95% / measured UX maturity)